

cursor; it isn't usually advisable, but does save a little effort for the lazy ones.

To make straight-edged selections, you can use the Polygonal Lasso tool. While you click away at different points in your image, the Polygonal Lasso



The Selection on the top was drawn using the Freehand Lasso; the one below was drawn with the Polygonal Lasso

will create an irregular polygon that will then become the selection. If you want to delete a few line segments, use either the [Backspace] or [Delete] keys to delete the preceding line segments and start again. To close the selection's boundary, you can either bring the polygon back to the point where you started, or double-click where you want to stop—the selection boundary will close by joining the first point to the point where you double-clicked.

To make perfect-edged selections with the Polygonal Lasso, hold down [Shift]. The angles of the selection lines will now follow 45-degree increments.

3.2.2 The Magnetic Lasso

One of the most powerful selection tools is the Magnetic Lasso —especially if you want to extract parts of an image from a background. It's perfect if drawing freehand selections with the Lasso isn't your strength. It works by analysing the contrast at the meeting of two colours—if the difference is high enough, the selection boundary “sticks” to the edge between the colours. For example, if you had a dark coloured blob on a white background, the Magnetic Lasso is just the tool to extract the blob from its background.